

Of course, a lot of you just might have everything it takes to start your own web services company. What we're going to do next is to list out the skills we think are important for you to be able to make a successful go at an attempt to make some serious money, in no particular order of importance.

1.2.1 Dedication

This one comes from personal experience of Team Digit. There's no substitute to dedication to a cause, and this applies to not just this business you're trying to start, but to all aspects of life. However, sticking to the topic, too often we've seen people who have a lot of skills lose interest, or lose patience in a task or project. Don't invest your time or money in a project (or people, even) that you're not dedicated enough to. If you're driven, passionate and determined to succeed, you will.

1.2.2 Knowledge

In this day and age, with so many people interested in learning about technology, and in fact, so many Digit readers out there, you better know your stuff. There's nothing more off-putting than someone trying to sell you something they're not really educated about enough themselves, and even worse when you know more about the product or service than the one selling them. Make sure to read, read and then read some more on the topics, and understand all there is to know. This is even more important for a service provider, because you need to have the answers to any questions that your clients might have.

The services you provide might involve anything from writing simple HTML code to modifying PHP code, and troubleshooting a rogue CMS. Before you start offering solutions that include such products as CMSes, make sure you read up about them, use them and get accustomed to them.

1.2.3 Design sensibility

In order to be able to market yourself as a serious web service professional, you need to be able to deliver products that not only work well, but also look good too. For example, if your first client needs you to set up a basic site for him or her, that just lists the company's contact information and what they do, there's almost no coding to speak of, and you should be able to get the site up in a day. However, if you don't design it well, and follow design guidelines, you will end up with a site that works perfectly, but doesn't look good to the client. This will result in multiple re-iterations and thus more of your time, and also probably won't earn you brownie point with your client, and thus ensure that you don't get recommendations or referrals from that client.